Knut Niemann

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Education

Ph.D. in Economics, University of Tübingen Overall grade: *summa cum laude*	10/2019 – 12/2023
M.Sc. in Economics and Finance, University of Tübingen	10/2017 – 09/2019
B.Sc. in Economics and Business Administration, University of Tübingen	10/2012 – 09/2016

Fields of Interest

Applied microeconomics, international economics, expectation formation, political economy

Academic Positions

Postdoctoral Researcher, Prof. Dr. Anna Gumpert, University of Tübingen	10/2023 – present
Doctoral Student, Prof. Dr. Gernot Müller, University of Tübingen	10/2019 – 06/2023

External Experience and Stays Abroad

Visiting Researcher, Danmarks Nationalbank, Copenhagen	04/2026 – 05/2026
Intern Directorate General Economics, Bundesbank, Frankfurt	05/2022 – 09/2022
Visiting Student, University of Massachusetts, Amherst	09/2014 – 05/2015

Job Market Paper

Political Distance and Trade, latest version
Single-authored

Using UN voting disagreement and structural gravity for 167 countries over 1966–2020, I find that a typical within-pair standard-deviation increase in political distance is associated with about 3 percent lower trade. In the unrestricted sample, responsiveness peaks in the late Cold War, weakens during 1995–2007, and subsequently strengthens without regaining its peak. Sanctions and security-related disagreement favour a trade-cost interpretation. Under this interpretation, restoring 1962 political alignments lowers welfare in about 70 percent of economies, mainly in Europe, while the Americas gain; late-Cold-War responsiveness amplifies these effects.

An earlier version was discussed in the IRC report "The EU's Open Strategic Autonomy from a central banking perspective."

Publications

Firm expectations about production and prices: Facts, determinants, and effects, pub. version with Benjamin Born, Zeno Enders, and Gernot Müller, in: Rüdiger Bachmann, Giorgio Topa, and Wilbert van der Klaauw, eds., **Handbook of Economic Expectations**, Elsevier, 2023, pp. 355–383.

Working Papers

Firm Expectations and News: Micro v Macro, latest version
with Benjamin Born, Zeno Enders, Manuel Menkhoff, and Gernot Müller
Revise & Resubmit at **American Economic Journal: Macroeconomics**

How do firms distinguish news about their own business from news about the aggregate economy? Using German and Italian firm surveys, we relate forecast errors to revisions in expectations and find systematic overreaction to firm-specific news but underreaction to aggregate news. A model of "island illusion," in which firms underestimate the importance of aggregate developments for their own performance, explains both patterns. Embedding this mechanism in a noisy-information model shows how these expectation errors affect aggregate outcomes.

Political Shocks, Interstate Migration, and Geographic Polarization, latest version
with Jonas Adolph

We study whether political events change both how many people move and where they go. Combining county-to-county migration flows with 45 close US gubernatorial elections between 1994 and 2014, we compare counties supporting the losing and winning parties in stacked event studies. Outmigration from losing-party counties rises by 3.21 percent over the first five post-election years, while destination choices shift towards strongholds of the losing party. The departure response is concentrated in elections with larger ideological gaps between candidates. A migration-selection model connects these findings and shows how political shocks can reinforce geographic sorting.

Work in progress

Tariffs and Danish Exports: Insights from Three Decades of Microdata,
with Henrik Yde Andersen, Mathias Klein, and Thomas Krause

How do exporters in a small open economy respond to foreign tariff changes? We link Danish customs records, firm balance sheets, and destination-specific tariffs from 1993 to 2021. Comparing the same firm's exports of a product across destinations, we use local projections to trace adjustments in export revenues, quantities, and unit values. Preliminary results suggest that higher foreign tariffs reduce both quantities and export unit values, consistent with exporters absorbing part of the tariff increase. We also examine employment, investment, and destination diversification, with initial evidence pointing to limited domestic adjustment and possible expansion into additional markets.

Presentations

2026 EEA-ESEM Meeting (Dublin);
European Trade Study Group (ETSG; University of Exeter);
XXVII Conference on International Economics (Ciudad Real; 2 papers); Danmarks Nationalbank

2025 RWTH Aachen; RSIT Brown Bag (Tübingen); Macro Brown Bag (Tübingen)

2024 Tübingen-Hohenheim-Economics Workshop (Discussant); Macro Brown Bag (Tübingen)

2023 Macro Brown Bag (Tübingen, twice)

2022 Bundesbank internal seminars; BoE-BdF-BBk-ECB Global Economy Meeting (Eltville); Dynare Conference (Lancaster); DFG Priority Programme 1859 online seminar

Grants and Awards

2026 Conference travel support, Friedrich-List-Stiftung (EUR 1,058.94), for the XXVII Conference on International Economics, Ciudad Real, Spain

Teaching Experience

Master Thesis Supervision (8 submitted) 2024–2026

Master Seminar (co-taught) 2024–2026
2025: 1.2 / 1.1

Advanced International Trade Theory (Lecture + Tutorial Coordination, Master) 2024–2026
2025: 1.6 / 1.2; 2026: 1.7 / 1.5

Firms in the Global Economy (Lecture + Tutorial, Bachelor) 2023–2026
2024: 2.0 / 1.3; 2025: 1.6 / 1.1

Bachelor Tutorials 2016–2022
Macroeconomics I (3x), Exploratory Data Analysis, Probability and Risk, Quantitative Methods, Intermediate Microeconomics

Evaluations are course / instructor averages on a 1–5 scale (1 = very good, 5=insufficient).

Refereeing

Economics Letters, European Economic Review

Additional Information

Languages: German (native), English (fluent), Italian (basic), French (basic)

Research software: Stata, MATLAB, R, LaTeX

Service: Board Member and Treasurer of SSC Tübingen e.V. since 2017 (responsible for the finances of a multi-sport club with more than 1,000 members)

References

Prof. Dr. Gernot Müller
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